regroup. At 11.15 a.m., the Chinese opened fire again with medium artillery, heavy and medium mortars. After thirty minutes of intense and fairly accurate bombardment, Chinese infantry, their numbers tripled after the capture of Srijap Jamini and Srijap East, closed in from three sides. Thapa ordered his men to hold their fire. Despite severe casualties, Charlie Company did not waver, opening up with all weapons at short range, forcing the Chinese to break contact yet again.

Raina in the meantime had asked Lieutenant Colonel Hari Chand to get a volunteer who could take a storm boat from Tokung and find out what was happening in Srijap and Yula. Naik Rabi Lal, despite the inherent dislike of Gorkhas for water, immediately volunteered. As he approached Srijap East, the boat was fired at from three or four positions, including Srijap Jamini that was by then under Chinese control. After reporting on the Srijap situation, the NCO headed east, keeping the southern bank of the Pangong Tso to his right. Here too he could see both Yula I and Yula II under heavy enemy fire. Rabi Lal returned to Tokung by 11.45 a.m.

The third assault came at 4 p.m., with a dozen Chinese tanks supporting the infantry. Every Gorkha at Srijap knew by then that he was going to die, but to surrender the post was unthinkable. Thapa was wounded, but so long as his men could see him, they fought on. Eventually, he was brought down and by 9 a.m. on 22 October, the Chinese had captured Srijap West. In the fight for Srijap East and Srijap West, forty-one men had been killed. Of these, sixteen had been wounded but were taken alive by the Chinese. To the horror of an eyewitness who had been captured, fifteen of the sixteen wounded men were executed. The only casualty who had been spared on account of his rank badges was Major Dhan Singh Thapa who was amazingly still alive.

Both the captured riflemen, one each from Srijap East and Srijap West, managed to escape from the Chinese and make their way to Chartse, an Indian supply point. Three more survivors eventually joined them. All the men claimed that the company commander had been killed in the fighting. Much later, after the Indian government had conferred a Param Vir Chakra posthumously to the officer, Radio Peking would announce that Major Dhan Singh Thapa was in fact alive and was a POW.

In the Yula Sector, the Chinese, on 20 October had dispatched a column of 200 men along with yaks and porters that would bypass Jamini Tilok and Yula II and attack Yula I further to the west. They hoped for a quick capture